SteelyDanReviews

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Katy Lied

Side A: Black Friday, Bad Sneakers, Rose Darling, DDLITNYCNM, Doctor Wu

Foreword

I love *Aja*, I love *The Royal Scam*, and I love *Katy Lied*. I love Steely Dan. I love my mom and dad. I love my girlfriend. These are all true statements of, in all earnesty, similar magnitude. Surely you love an album in a different way than a cherished family member or romantic partner, but all that I can say is this: in the ways that I *love Steely Dan*, I love them a lot. A whole lot! They changed my life! I cannot fully express the unfathomable vastness of my love for Steely Dan in mere words. But as they would say in Mandarin, wo xi huan Steely Dan. With that, lets attempt to quantify my love for Katy Lied with words and numbers.

Black Friday

I love the hook in Black Friday, I love the exaggeration on socks and shoes, I love Michael McDonald, I love Denny Dias. Just a rockin song, one of their best true rock songs. The outro solo is a lot of fun too.

Bad Sneakers

So weird, and so captivating instantly. I'm goooooing insane, and I'm laughing at the frozen rain, it's all amazing leadin gup to the first chorus hit, and... What? What did he just say? It's so great and then chills back out into the White Suit and then before you know it the chorus!!! And Michael McDonald!!! And an even HARDER hit with the drums, this song fucking rocks. And the guitar solo is so good, so intimate and the keys in the back are so perfect. There's a sorta island vibe in the song but like everything is just played so hard and so emphatically it all works SO well. Donald's voice is amazing, the instrumentation, it's all amazing I love Bad Sneakers. 10/10

Rose Darling

Rose Darling sorta draws you in early with some interesting imagery, then they sorta feint a movement towards a chorus, you forget about that momentum hearing "I would guess she's in Detroit, with lots of money in the bank, although I could be wrong.", and then they go into ONE OF THE BEST CHORUS'S OF ALL TIME, MIKEY MCD IS AMAZING, DONALD I LOVE YOU, and then the extremely tasteful guitar solo. One thing about a band like Steely Dan, is they're gonna find a way to get you SO into an incredible hook, and then keep coming back to that mf JUST enough times, and then one more because it's really that good. 10/10

Daddy Don't Live in that New York City No More

I love this song *after* Rose Darling. In the context of the album it's an incredibly fun, bluesy song with a lot of nice playing up and down. This is one of the biggest growers for me, initially not a huge fan but after like 10 listens you start bopping along with it, fucking with the guitar heavy as shit, and by like 50 listens it's like hold up this song is just awesome. If you don't like Donald here or something or the lyrics offend you so be it but it slams man. 8.8/10

Doctor Wu

This song AFTER DDLITNYCNM IS INSANE!!! IT'S MADNESS!!! It's so fun, man. But so beautiful too. Donald sings so beautifully and it's so sincere. The Rhodes in the back with the drums driving all song, "have you done all you can do", and then the sax! One of the best Steely Dan songs for saxophones (and I am aware there's a lot of sax), the solo takes you from a HUGE high, then gently caresses your heart, brings you back into the wilderness before the emotional storm comes back again. "Katy Lies! You can see it in her eyes!" is so perfect! It draws you into a sorta emotional high and you're so prepared to get back into wondering if Doctor Wu is there or not. This is one of their best songs truly and it's such a nice end of the side of the album too. 10/10, would go higher.

Sidea